

The Dhāraṇī of Paying Homage

Toh 780 · Derge Kangyur

ཕགྱ་བ་བྱུང་གི་ཐུངས།

This short text is a collection of dhāraṇīs, which the Tibetan colophon-style lines suggest was transmitted under a title along the lines of the dhāraṇī of paying homage and the dhāraṇī for obtaining a hundred cloths, though the full original title is not preserved in the lines given and a Sanskrit or Tibetan title cannot be stated with confidence. It consists of brief protective and prosperity-bringing formulas: a homage to Mañjuśrī, said to ward off the harm of epidemic disease, followed by a dhāraṇī addressed to the Three Jewels and to Vajrapāṇi, the fierce great commander of the yakṣas. The second dhāraṇī is accompanied by simple ritual instructions, to be recited a thousand times over a bundle of cloth, which is then gifted to a suitable person, with the promise that a hundred bundles will be obtained within half a month, and with the same result said to follow when wealth, food, or means of travel are used instead. It is Toh 780 in the Kangyur, belonging to the class of dhāraṇī texts, in the Tantra division of the collection, where short spells of this kind address worldly needs such as health and material well-being.

...and the harm of epidemic disease will not arise.

Oṃ namo mañjuśrīye. Namaḥ suśrīye. Namo uttamaśrīye svāhā.

Here ends the dhāraṇī of paying homage.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the great commander of the yakṣas, Vajrapāṇi, the Fierce One.

Iri miri, dhadaṃ me, bahu phalaṃ bhavatu svāhā.

Recite this one thousand times over a single bundle of cloth, and then give it to a person of noble family, or to a teacher, or to anyone else who is suitable. Within half a month, one will obtain a hundred bundles of cloth. In the same way, if this is done with wealth or food, or with any suitable means of travel, the result is the same.

Here ends the dhāraṇī for obtaining a hundred cloths.

Translator's Notes

• The opening line is the tail of the preceding text, so it is rendered as a fragment. The mantra syllables are given in the Sanskrit reconstruction of the Tibetan transliteration; "dhadaṃ me" and "iri miri" are not clearly intelligible Sanskrit and are given as they stand. The word

rendered "person of noble family" (འཇམ་མགས་པོ་འཇམ་མགས་པོ་) is uncertain; it may mean a person of good lineage or a gentleman. The word rendered "means of travel" (འཇམ་མགས་པོ་འཇམ་མགས་པོ་) is literally "something that goes on foot," probably meaning livestock or other conveyance, and its sense here is not certain.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.